

Marshall Acton III

The definition of luxury listening experience

₹31,999



Marshall has been known to make speakers that are renowned for their sound and build quality. Across their lineup, the brand has products that are awe-inspiring, a bit pricey, but worth the money you spend on it. While this may seem like a great thing for the brand, it is what makes placing these speakers against others that are out there somewhat difficult. What you get in terms of build and design, you lose out in terms of features that many others come packing with, especially at the price that Marshall speakers retail at. So, when the Marshall Acton III showed up, I had a lot of questions that I wanted answers to. I set out to explore what the speaker had to offer, putting it through our test process in order to find out if it warrants its price of ₹31,999. Here's what I found out –

BUILD AND DESIGN

There is no denying that Marshall is leagues above all other brands in the business when it comes to building and



designing speakers that scream out quality as you lay your hand on them.

With the black leather finish on the body, with tastefully selected mesh front covering the drivers, gold accents and the logo rounding up the front,

and the metal knobs and switches making up the top control assembly, Marshall Acton III was everyone's favourite at the Digit Test Centre. On the back of the speaker, you get tons of labelling, the outlet for the woofer, the power cable port, and the cutout for the service port.

The control hub, which is gold in colour, complimenting the gold and black aesthetic of the speaker, houses the flick-switch for power, the source selector, AUX port (3.5mm in), the two-way joystick for playback control, and three knobs for volume, treble, and bass control. This is one of the most complete control hubs that I have seen on a Bluetooth speaker, and being a fan of physical controls, I love it. The knobs have lights around the perimeter telling you what level the bass/treble/volume is

set to, and the subtle stepped action on them adds to the overall premium feel and experience of using the Marshall Acton III.

On the bottom, you get four rubber feet which keep the speaker held in place even when you crank up the bass and volume to the max. I played hours of FI 23 on this speaker, and it managed to stay put despite the constant rumbling of the cars on the track. The experience, you ask? Well, I will talk about it later.

As for the robustness of the speaker, unless you are planning to take it outdoors, I think you should not be worried about the build of the speaker. The mesh on the front will need to be dusted from time to time to protect its sheen, however, just regular wiping of the surface with a damp cloth should ensure that the speaker lasts a while before showing signs of wear and tear. If I were to draw parallels with cars, this speaker is like a luxury sedan that will drive well around the city on clean roads, but off-roading is not its cup of tea.

FEATURES

This is where Marshall Acton III loses out against the competition. We have speakers at this price, coming with a swanky feature set, which sometimes to be honest, gets a bit overwhelming for us to test out. However, with the Acton III, it was not the case. In fact, I believe Marshall's approach to this speaker was a bit too conservative. And that could be attributed to the unique positioning of this product. Let me explain.

The speaker, in order to provide a no bells and whistles, premium listening experience, loses out on essentials like the ability to daisy chain speakers to make a truly wireless stereo setup. There are a LOT of people who would chase down the most specced out speaker when they are spending close to ₹32K on a speaker. Only a small subset, which includes people who would give everything to have the best listening experience, would go for it. And, for those, having voice assistant support, or an extra bass boost button or a 100